

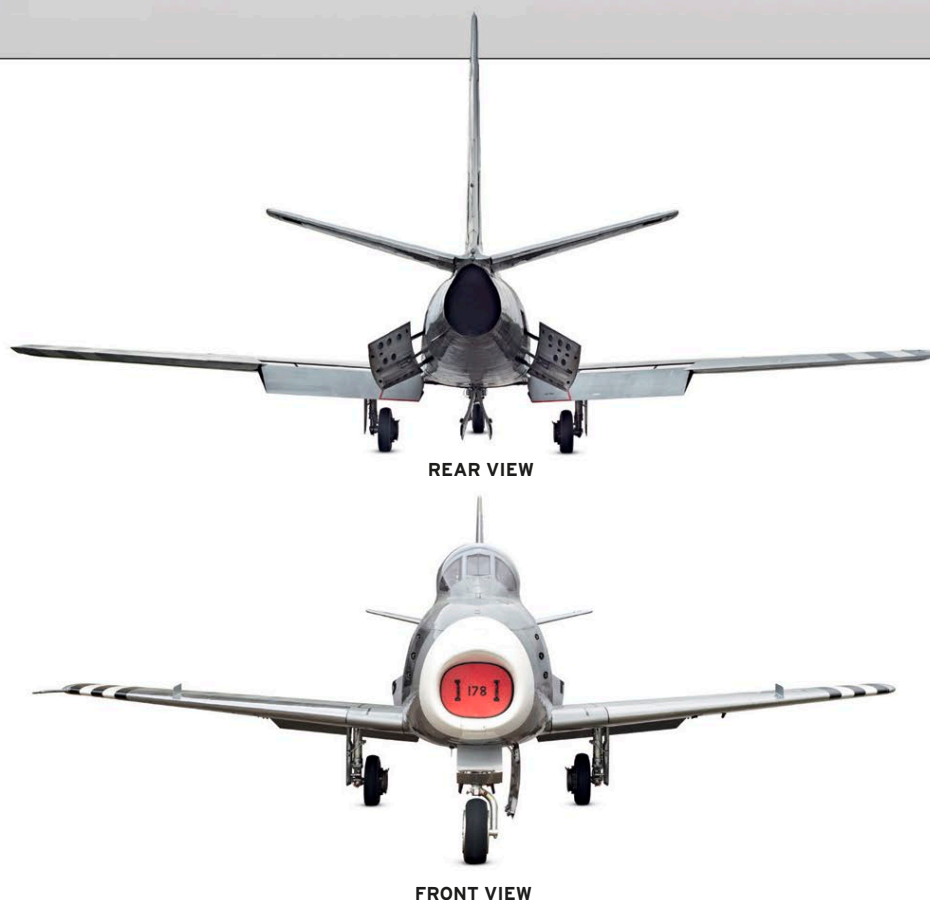
F-86 Sabre

With its sweptwing, gaping “mouth” and bubble canopy, the F-86 Sabre is one of the most distinctive and successful jet fighters in history. In World War II one generation of fighter pilots had earned their combat spurs flying the North American P-51, and their younger brothers took the same company’s next-generation fighter to war in Korea, where the agile Sabre fought nose-to-nose with the Soviet Union’s comparable MiG-15 fighter.

DEVELOPED FOR THE USAF as a medium-range day- and escort-fighter, North American’s F-86 was the result of combining a jet engine with a sweptwing—two developments (British and German respectively) that had been brought to fruition during World War II.

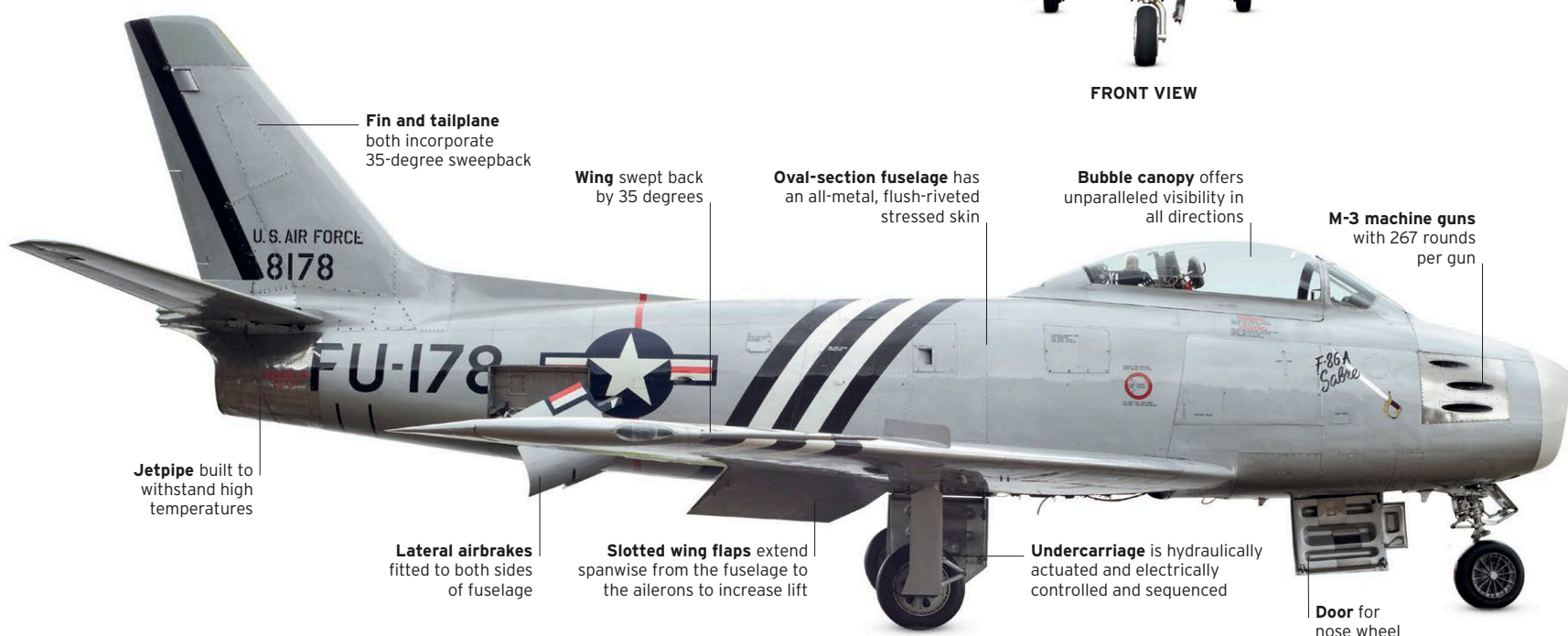
The resulting aircraft was a low-wing fighter with a jet engine fed by a straight-through flow of air from a distinctive nose intake and exhausting through a tailpipe at the back of the fuselage. The prototype XP-86 first flew in October 1947, and the aircraft exceeded Mach 1 the following year.

Fast and agile, the F-86A Sabre entered USAF service in early 1949 and was in front-line service when the forces of North Korea invaded South Korea in June 1950. The Sabre was called into action to be pitted against the Soviet Union’s equally state-of-the-art MiG-15. The dogfights between the two were brutal, but the nimble American fighter ultimately achieved a victory-to-loss ratio over its adversary of better than four to one.



REAR VIEW

FRONT VIEW



Fin and tailplane
both incorporate
35-degree sweepback

Wing swept back
by 35 degrees

Oval-section fuselage has
an all-metal, flush-riveted
stressed skin

Bubble canopy offers
unparalleled visibility in
all directions

M-3 machine guns
with 267 rounds
per gun

Jetpipe built to
withstand high
temperatures

Lateral airbrakes
fitted to both sides
of fuselage

Slotted wing flaps extend
spanwise from the fuselage to
the ailerons to increase lift

Undercarriage is hydraulically
actuated and electrically
controlled and sequenced

Door for
nose wheel